MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PLOTTING SET, THEODOLITE ML-625/GM

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of plotting set, designated ML-625/GM. It is used as an aid in computing winds aloft by graphic plotting techniques.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

L-M-530	Molding Plastic, Polyvinyl Chloride, Rigid
L-P-535	Plastic Sheet #Sheeting and Film#, Vinyl Chloride Polymer and Vinyl Chloride-Vinyl Acetate Copolymer, Rigid
NN-P-530	Plywood, Flat Panel
PPP-B-576	Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid
PPP-B-591	Box, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated
PPP-B-601	Box, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard
PPP-T-60	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof, for Packaging

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-143	Specifications and Standards Order of Precedence for the Selection of

FSC 6660

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MIL-STD-1186 Cushioning, Anchoring, Bracing, Blocking, and Waterproofing, with Appropriate Test Methods

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

REQUIREMENTS

3.1 This specification makes provision for preproduction testing.

3.2 Components.-The plotting set shall consist of:

Item No.	Quantity	Description	Requirement
1.	1 each	Base	3.7.1
2.	1 each	Azimuth A Scale	3.7.2
3.	1 each	Elevation Scale	3.7.3
4.	1 each	Azimuth B Scale	3.7.4
5.	1 each	Plotting Arm, Long	3.7.5
6.	1 each	Plotting Arm, Short	3.7.5
7.	1 each	Wind Direction Scale	3.7.6
8.	1 each	Wind Speed Scale	3.7.7
9.	1 each	Height Scale (3000' Baseline)	3.7.8

3.3 Selection of specifications and standards.-Specifications and and standards for necessary commodities and services not specified herein shall be selected according to MIL-STD-143.

3.4 Metals.-Metals shall be of the corrosion-resistant type or suitably treated to resist corrosion due to fuels, salt spray or atmospheric conditions likely to be met in storage or normal service.

3.5 Performance requirements.-The components of the plotting set shall retain the specified degree of flatness, permanency of bonding, transparency, freedom from warpage and corrosion, etc., when subjected to the following operating and storage conditions.

a. Service conditions, operating - Use in shelters with temperatures varying from 0 - 52°C (32° - 125°F) and relative humidities varying from 0 - 100 percent..

b. Service conditions, storage - Storage under temperature conditions ranging from minus 40°C to plus 54°C (minus 40°F to plus 130°F) and relative humidities varying from 0 - 100 percent.

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3.7 Details of components

3.7.1. Base.-The base (Figure 1) shall consist of:

a. Plywood base.

b. Plastic sheet bonded to the top side of the base.

c. A plastic sheet bonded to b. above.

d. A plastic sheet bonded to the bottom side of the base.

e. Binding strips.

f. Pivot.

g. Rubber support pads.

3.7.1.1 Plywood base.-The base shall be fabricated of hardwood (gum or birch) plywood conforming to NN-P-530. The base shall be 1.32 meters long, 91.4 centimeters (cm) wide, and approximately 13 millimeters (mm) thick. The surfaces of the plywood shall be suitably finished to meet the flatness requirements (3.9) and bonding requirements (3.11).

3.7.1.2 Top plastic sheet.-A plastic sheet shall be bonded to the upper surface of the base (3.7.1.1). The sheet material shall conform to L-P-535 and shall have a minimum thickness of 0.010 inch.

3.7.1.3 Plastic top layer.-A plastic top layer shall be bonded to the surface of the plastic sheet (3.7.1.2). The top layer shall be light green in color, and shall have a total thickness equal to the combined thickness of the Azimuth A (3.7.2) and Elevation (3.7.3) scales plus washers and hold-down screw head. The plastic shall conform to L-P-535. A circular cutout, 92.9 cm ±1 mm in diameter, and offset from the center 19 mm ±1/4 mm shall be provided in the top layer.

3.7.1.3.1 Marking.-A sharply pointed black arrow, labeled AZIMUTH A, shall be located as shown in Figure 1. This arrow shall be located on the centerline which is offset 19 mm from the center of the base. The arrow shall be printed or scribed on the light green plastic sheet (3.7.1.3).

3.7.1.4 Bottom plastic sheet.-A plastic sheet similar to that specified in paragraph 3.7.1.2 shall be bonded to the bottom surface of the plywood base.

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3.7.1.5 Binding strips.-Stainless steel binding strips shall be attached to the edges of the finished plotting board. The strips, shall be of angular cross section, with sides of approximately total board thickness by 1/4 inch. The strips shall be attached to the board in such a way that the widest side covers the edge of the plotting board. Corners shall be mitered. The binding strips shall not extend above the surface of the plotting board. The binding strips shall be secured to the edge of the board by relatively flat and smooth-headed wood screws which will not tend to cut or tear the clothing of the plotter when he rubs against the board's edge.

3.7.1.6 Pivot.-A stainless steel or nickel-plated steel pivot pin shall be provided on the base. The pivot shall be located at the center of the top layer cutout (3.7.1.3) within ±1/4 mm. The pivot shall be securely attached to the base. It shall be 1/2-inch in diameter and its length shall be sufficient to mount the Azimuth A and Elevation scales and nylon washers. The top of the pivot shall be flush with the top of the Elevation scale, when mounted.

3.7.1.7 Rubber support pads.-Eight rubber support pads, three at the top, three at the bottom and 2 in the center, shall be provided on the back side of the base. The pads shall be approximately 1/4-inch thick.

3.7.2 Azimuth A scale.-The Azimuth A scale (Figure 2) shall be constructed of laminations specified below, and shall have an overall thickness of 0.086 inch, ±.005 inch.

a. A bottom layer of opaque plastic.

b. A top layer of transparent plastic.

c. Inner layer of white paper, cloth or other material having the grid and scales printed thereon.

3.7.2.1 Bottom plastic layer.-Bottom layer shall be a one piece sheet of opaque plastic conforming to L-P-535. The lower surface shall have protuberances located 30° apart as shown in Figure 2.

3.7.2.2 Top plastic layer.-Top layer shall be one piece of transparent plastic conforming to L-P-535. It shall have a minimum thickness of 0.010 inch. This surface shall be smooth and transparent.

3.7.2.3 Printed scale.-The printed scale shall be a sheet of white paper, cloth or other material on which a fine grid has been printed. The grid lines shall be ruled in dark green 0.10 inch apart. The scale shall be bonded between the bottom (3.7.2.1) and top (3.7.2.2) plastic layers.

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3.7.2.3.1 Scale divisions.-A 360° scale with 0.20° divisions shall be located on the outer edge of the Azimuth A scale. The length of the division marks shall be as follows:

Divisions	Length
5°	5/16"
1°	1/4"
0.2°	3/16"

3.7.2.3.2 Scale division labeling.-The scale shall be labeled with two sets of numerals. The outside set, printed in black, shall be marked each 10°, beginning at 010° through 360°, counterclockwise. The 360° mark shall be diametrically opposite the 180° mark along a center line parallel to the horizontal grid lines (3.7.2.3). The second set of numerals, printed in dark red, shall be located inside the outer set, with 0° corresponding to 360°, then clockwise to 090° corresponding to 270° on the outer scale (see Figure 2). All numerals shall be 1/4" in height.

3.7.2.3.3 Horizontal coordinate axis.-The horizontal coordinate axis shall be a line from the center of the Azimuth A scale to the 180° mark. This line shall be dark red, and shall be 0.5 mm wide.

3.7.3 Elevation scale.-The elevation scale (Figure 3) shall be constructed of the laminations specified below and shall have an overall thickness of 0.06 inch, plus or minus .005:

a. A bottom layer of transparent plastic.

b. A top layer of transparent plastic.

3.7.3.1 Bottom layer.-The bottom layer shall be a one piece sheet of transparent plastic. A fine line (0.25 mm thick), an elevation indicator and the abbreviation "ELV" shall be printed on the top side in black by silk screen or equivalent process. Plastic shall conform to L-P-535. The bottom surface shall have protuberances located 30° apart as shown in Figure 2, but on a diameter as shown in Figure 3.

3.7.3.2 Top plastic layer.-The top layer shall be one piece of transparent plastic conforming to L-P-535. It shall have a minimum thickness of 0.010 inch. This surface shall be smooth and transparent.

3.7.4 Azimuth B scale.-The Azimuth B scale (Figure 4) shall be constructed of the laminates specified below and shall have an overall thickness of 0.086 inch, plus or minus .005 inch.

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a. A bottom layer of transparent plastic.

b. A top layer of transparent plastic.

3.7.4.1 Bottom plastic layer.-The bottom layer shall be a one piece sheet of transparent plastic conforming to L-P-535. The lower surface shall be smooth. A 360° scale shall be printed on the top side with 0.2° divisions and labeled at each 10° of the arc. The length of the divisions shall be as follows:

Divisions	Length
5°	5/16"
1°	1/4"
0.2°	3/16"

3.7.4.1.1 The 360° scale, numbered clockwise, shall be printed in black by the silk screen or equivalent process. The scale shall be positioned as shown in Figure 4. The numerals shall be 3/16 inch high.

3.7.4.2 Plastic top layer.-The top layer shall be of single sheet construction, if practicable. If two pieces are required, the finished surface shall be smooth and without sensible discontinuity along joint. Sheet material shall conform to L-P-535, and shall have a minimum thickness of 0.010 inch. The top surface shall be given a dull finish which will take the mark of a medium hard pencil or ink, readily producing a clean, clear line. It shall be sufficiently transparent so that all lines and marking of the scales mounted below are distinctly visible. When the set is in operational use, frequent cleaning of the surface with soap and water is essential. The surface shall be sufficiently hard so that repeated erasures, with a soft eraser, will not cut it perceptibly.

3.7.4.3 Pivot assembly.-The pivot assembly shall be flanged and fastened to the lower side of the Azimuth B scale. The pivot assembly shall be made of nickel-plated or stainless steel. Each plotting arm (3.7.5) shall fit on the pivot and rotate freely without excessive play. The pivot assembly shall be similar to that shown in Figure 4.

3.7.4.3.1 Pivot location.-The pivot shall be located within ±1/4 mm of the center of the scale (3.7.1.1).

3.7.5 Plotting arms.-Two plotting arms shall be provided. The plotting arms shall be fabricated of plastic conforming to L-P-535, Composition B, Type I, Grade B. Each arm shall be 0.250" ±005" thick and 1-1/4" ± 1/32" wide. The configuration of the plotting arms shall be as specified in

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Figure 5. Provision shall be made for attaching the plotting arms to the Azimuth B scale by means of the pivot assembly (3.7.4.3). One plotting arm shall be 14" long, the other shall be 28" long.

3.7.6 Wind direction scale.-A wind direction scale fabricated of laminated transparent plastic sheet conforming to L-P-535 shall be provided. The scale images as shown in Figure 6 shall be printed in durable black, and located, after lamination, between plastic sheets. Total thickness shall not exceed 0.045 inch.

3.7.7 Wind speed scale.-The wind speed scale shall be fabricated of laminated transparent plastic sheet conforming to L-P-535. The scale images as shown in Figure 7 printed in durable black, shall be located, after lamination, between plastic sheets. Total thickness shall not exceed 0.065 inch.

3.7.8 Height scale.-Height scales shall be one piece of transparent plastic, 0.06 inch thick, 1.5 inch wide, and 18 inches long. A center line separates the two height scales. Scale image A and B shall be printed in durable black by the silk screen or equivalent process. Scales shall be as shown in Figure 9. The scale values represent height in feet.

3.7.9 Assembly.-The Azimuth A scale, and Elevation scale shall be mounted to the base by means of the pivot (3.7.1.6). The scales shall be separated at the pivot with nylon washers 1/2 inch I. D., by 1-1/4 inch O. D., by 0.015 inch thick.

3.7.9.1 Azimuth B scale assembly.-The Azimuth B scale (3.7.4) is located on top of the base (3.7.1). Metal pins shall be provided for mounting. The metal pins shall be nickel-plated steel or stainless steel and of the size shown in Figure 8. Location of the pins in the base (3.7.1) shall be such to allow placing of the Azimuth B scale in three positions.

a. Position 1: The center of the Azimuth B scale is 30 cm $\pm$1/4 mm from the center of the Azimuth A scale (3.7.2) on a line through the center of the Azimuth A scale and the Azimuth arrow on the base (3.7.1.3).

b. Position 2: The center of the Azimuth B scale shall be 10 cm $\pm$1/4 mm from the center of the Azimuth A scale on the same line as Position 1.

c. Position 3: The center of the Azimuth B scale shall be 5 cm $\pm$1/4 mm from the center of the Azimuth A scale on the same line as Position 1.

3.10 Flatness.-There shall be no evidence of waves or ripples on any plastic surface of the board when viewed at an angle of 30° to the line of sight of the observer. The total deviation from a flat surface shall not exceed 1 mm in either width or length.

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3.11 Accuracy.-All scale division marks on the angular scales shall register within 0.05' of the correct position.

3.12 Bonding.-All laminated parts shall be uniformly bonded throughout. There shall be no bubbles in the surface due to separation of the laminated layers of the plastic material. The quality of the bonding shall be such that no separation will occur when any part of the plotting board is exposed to service conditions.

3.13 Interchangeability.-All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable.

3.14 Identification of product.-Equipment, assemblies and parts shall be marked for identification. The contractor shall provide part and order number information at appropriate locations.

3.15 Workmanship.-The plotting set, including all parts and accessories, shall be constructed in a thoroughly workmanlike manner. Particular attention shall be given to freedom from blemishes and defects: Accuracy of dimensions, straightedges, tightness of screws, markings; and freedom of parts from burrs and sharp edges. All laminated plastic parts shall be free from bubbles and warpage after lamination. Where plastic is bonded to wood or metal surfaces, the plastic shall show no signs of separation.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of tests.-The inspection and testing of plotting sets shall be classified as follows:

a. Acceptance tests (4.3)

b. Preproduction tests (4.6).

4.3 Acceptance tests.-Acceptance tests shall consist of:

a. Individual tests (4.3.1)

b. Sampling plans and tests (4.3.2).

4.3.1 Individual tests.-Each plotting set shall be subjected to the

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following tests as described under 4.5, Test methods, of this specification:

a. Examination of product (4.5.1)

b. Functional tests (4.5.2).

4.3.2 Sampling plans and tests.-Two plotting sets which have been manufactured under essentially the same conditions shall be selected at random from each 100, or fraction thereof produced on the order, and subjected to the tests described under 4.5.3 and 4.5.4.

4.3.2.1 Rejection and retest.-When one item selected from a production run fails to meet the specification, no items on hand, or later produced, shall be accepted until the extent and cause of the failure are determined. After corrections have been made, all necessary tests shall be repeated.

4.3.2.2 Individual tests may continue.-For operational reasons, individual tests may be continued pending investigation of a sampling test failure. But, final acceptance of items on hand, or produced later, shall not be made until it has been determined that items meet all requirements of the specification.

4.3.2.3 Defects in items already accepted.-The investigation of a test failure could indicate that defects may exist in items already accepted. If so, the contractor shall fully advise the procuring activity of all defects likely to be found and methods of correcting them.

4.4 Test conditions

4.4.1 Atmospheric conditions.-Unless otherwise specified, all tests required by this specification shall be made at an atmospheric pressure of 28 to 32 inches of mercury and at a temperature of 25 degrees C, plus or minus 10 degrees C, and a relative humidity of 80 percent or less. Where tests are made with atmospheric pressure or temperature substantially different from the above values, proper allowances shall be made for the changes in instrument reading.

4.5 Test methods

4.5.1 Examination of product.-Each plotting set shall be inspected to determine compliance with this specification with respect to material, dimensions, markings, workmanship, and conformance to figures.

4.5.2 Functional tests

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4.5.2.1 Dimensions and markings.-Dimensions and markings of the scales and protractors may be measured by means of a template. Particular attention shall be given to accuracy of straight-edges and flatness of plotting surfaces. The angular scales shall be checked with an accurate protractor at a minimum of eight graduation marks selected at random within the scales. Linear scales shall be checked with an accurate rule at a minimum of eight graduation marks selected at random within each scale.

4.5.3 Finish test.-A line shall be drawn on the surface of the Azimuth B scale with a No. 2 lead pencil as used in ordinary handwriting. The resulting line shall be solid, dense, and have well defined edges. The line shall be easily removed with a pencil eraser. The same test shall be repeated using a pen and any commercial writing ink of permanent or washable type.

4.5.4 Performance tests.-After subjection to the service conditions specified in 4.5.4.1, the set shall meet the following tests:

a. When placed on a flat surface, the base and the Azimuth B scale shall lie flat with no point more than 1/16 inch above the flat surface. The laminated surfaces of the base and all other scales shall show no signs of discoloration or separation of the laminations.

b. The plotting arms (3.7.5) shall lie perfectly flat and show no signs of discoloration or separation of the plastic edges.

4.5.4.1 Service conditions.-The plotting set shall be tested for compliance with the requirements of 3.6 as follows:

4.5.4.1.1 Operating conditions.-The plotting set shall be maintained at a temperature of 0 degrees C for a minimum of 2 hours. Immediately after removal from the 0 degrees C environment, the acceptance tests shall be repeated and there shall be no evidence of inability to meet these tests. The set shall then be maintained at a temperature of 52 degrees C for a period of 2 hours. The acceptance tests shall be repeated immediately after removal of the set from the 52 degrees C environment. The plotting set shall meet the requirements of the acceptance tests.

4.5.4.1.2 Storage conditions.-The following tests shall be conducted. Successful completion of the humidity test shall constitute compliance with high temperature storage requirements. These tests shall be conducted in the shipping configuration.

a. Humidity.-In accordance with Method 507, Procedure I of MIL-STD-810, except that the maximum temperature shall be 54 degrees C instead of the specified 71 degrees C and the number of cycles shall be reduced to two.

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b. Low temperature.-The plotting set shall be maintained at minus 40 degrees C for a minimum of 6 hours. Upon return to temperatures within the operating range (0 degree C to 52 degrees C) the plotting set shall meet all the requirements of the acceptance tests.

4.6 Preproduction testing

4.6.1 Preproduction test samples.-When specified in the contract, the preproduction test samples shall consist of two models representative of the production equipment. They shall be tested at a laboratory designated by the procuring activity or, when so stated in the contract, at the contractor's plant under the supervision of the procuring activity.

4.6.2 Preproduction tests.-Preproduction tests shall consist of all tests described under 4.5, Test methods.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging

5.1.1 Level A.-Plotting sets shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, Method I C, and packaged in containers meeting requirements of PPP-B-576, PPP-B-591, PPP-B-601, PPP-B-621, and PPP-B-636. As far as practical, exterior containers shall be of uniform shape and size, be of minimum cube and tare consistent with protection required, and contain identical quantities. The gross weight of each pack shall be limited to approximately 200 pounds. Strapping and closure shall be in accordance with the applicable container specification and the appendix thereto. Containers shall be provided with a case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547 and shall be sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. As an alternate to the case liner, PPP-B-636 containers may be sealed at all joints and seams with tape conforming to PPP-T-60.

5.2.2 Level B.-The plotting set, preserved and packaged to meet 5.1.1, shall be packed in domestic-type exterior containers meeting requirements of PPP-B-576, PPP-B-591, PPP-B-601, PPP-B-621, and PPP-B-636. Exterior containers shall be of minimum cube and tare consistent with the protection required. As far as practical, exterior containers shall be of uniform shape and size and contain identical quantities. The gross weight of each pack shall be limited to approximately 500 pounds. Containers shall be closed and strapped in accordance with applicable container specification or appendix thereto. When fiberboard containers are used, the fiberboard shall meet the special requirement table of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.3 Level C.-Packages which require overpacking for acceptance by the carrier shall be packed in exterior-type shipping containers in a manner that will insure safe transportation at the lowest rate to the point of delivery. Containers shall meet Consolidated Freight Classification Rules or regulations of common carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Physical protection.-Cushioning, blocking, bracing, and bolting as required shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1186 except that for domestic shipments, waterproof requirements for cushioning materials and containers shall be waived. Drop tests of MIL-STD-1186 shall be waived when preservation, packaging, and packing of the item is for immediate use or when the drop tests of MIL-P-116 are applicable.

5.4 Marking.-Interior and exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Nomenclature shall be as follows:

Plotting Set, Theodolite ML-625/GM

5.4.1 Additional marking not covered by MIL-STD-129.-The following marking shall also be added:

IF IN STORAGE AFTER (DATE)[1], THE PLOTTING SET SHALL BE TESTED AND INSPECTED BEFORE ISSUE.

[1]This date shall be 3 years from date of inspection.

6. NOTES

6.1 Use. The Plotting Set, Theodolite ML0625/GM, covered by this specification is intended for use by weather personnel in the determination of winds aloft, as measured by theodolite equipment called Theodolite, Double Center ML-474.

6.2 Ordering data.-Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Number of preproduction samples and point of testing.

c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation, packaging, and packing desired.

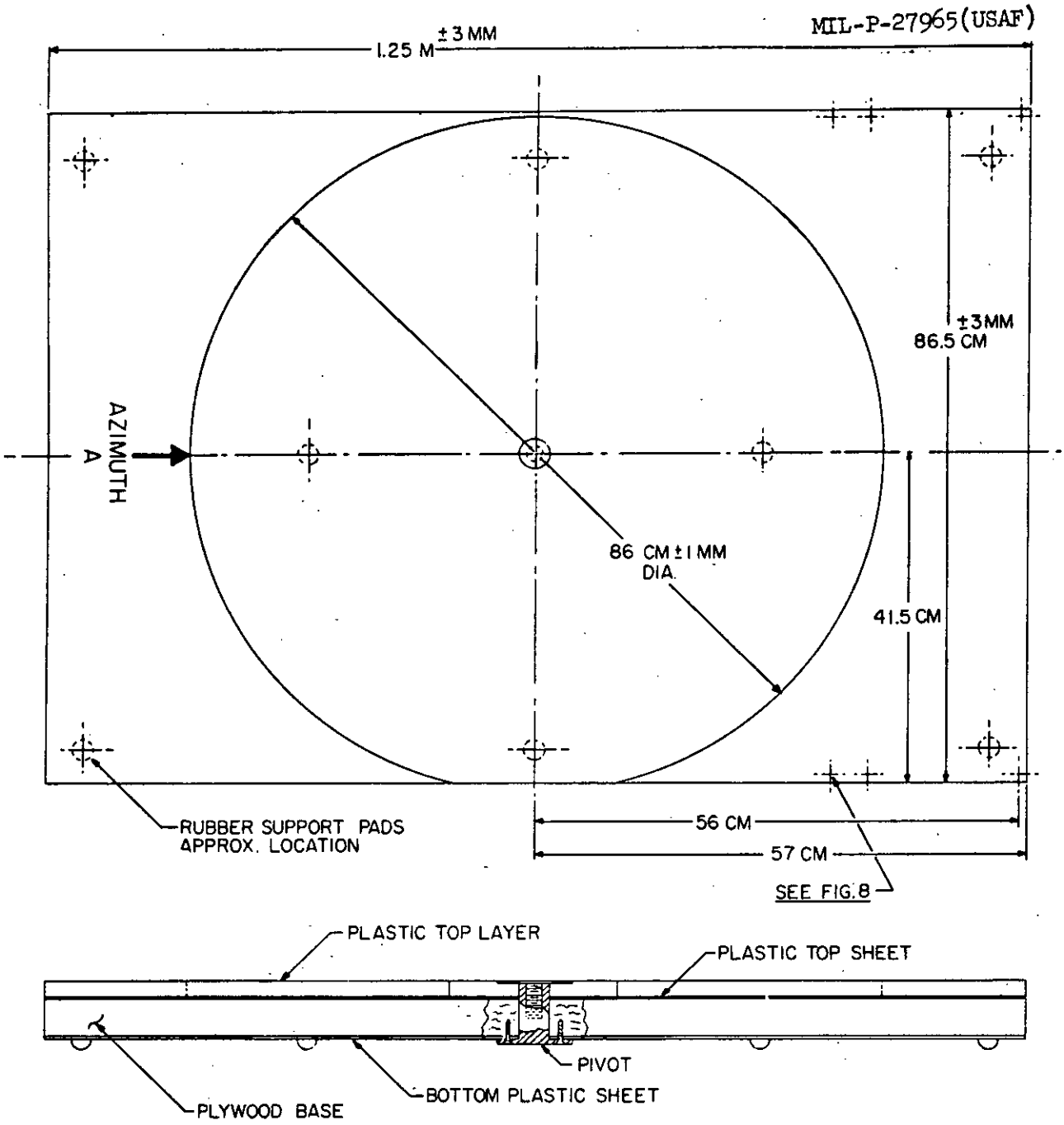
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NOTE: NOT TO SCALE

FIGURE 1: BASE

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NOTES:
1. INTERMEDIATE GRADUATIONS NOT SHOWN
SEE PARA. 3.7.2.3.1
2. NOT TO SCALE

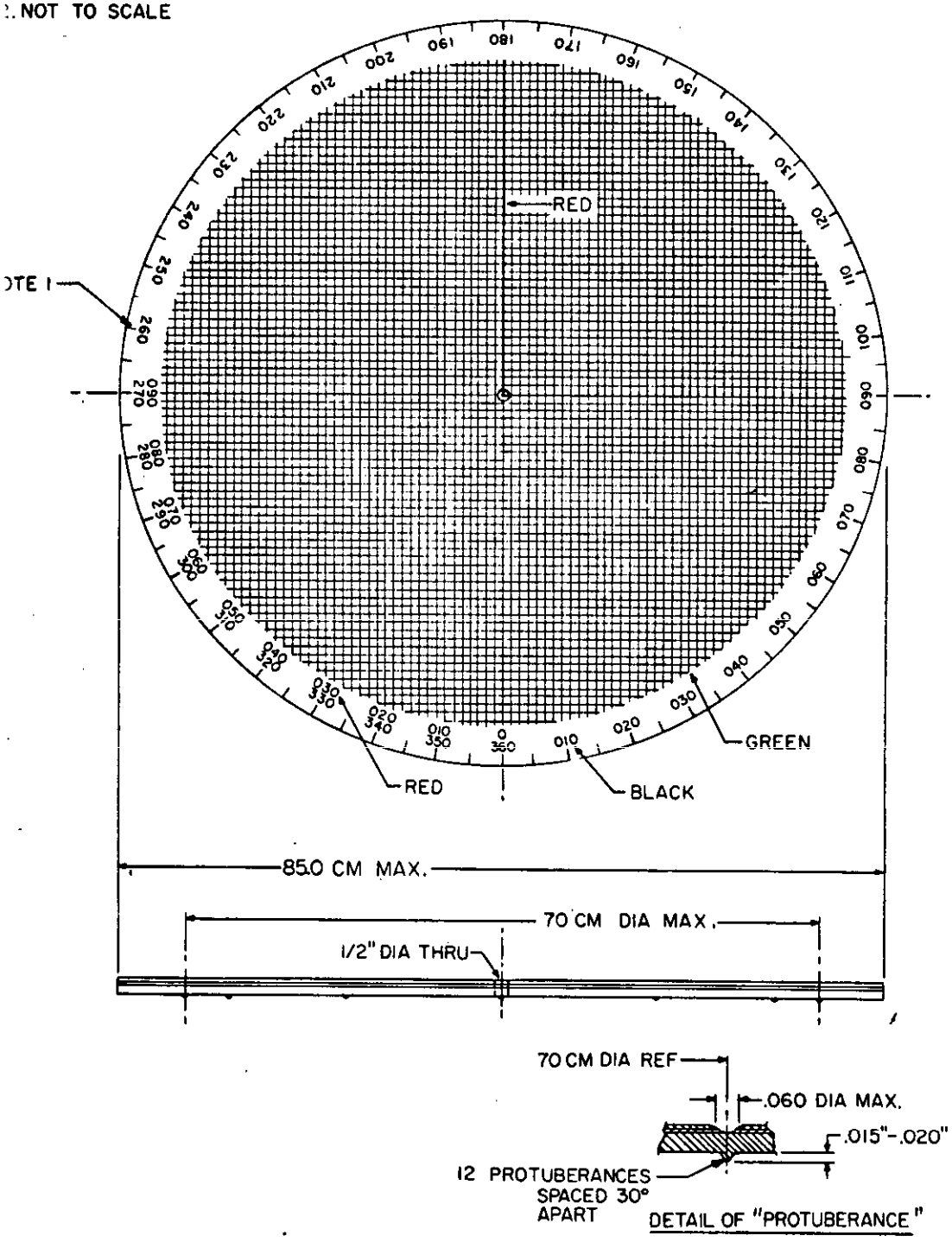


FIGURE 2: AZIMUTH A SCALE

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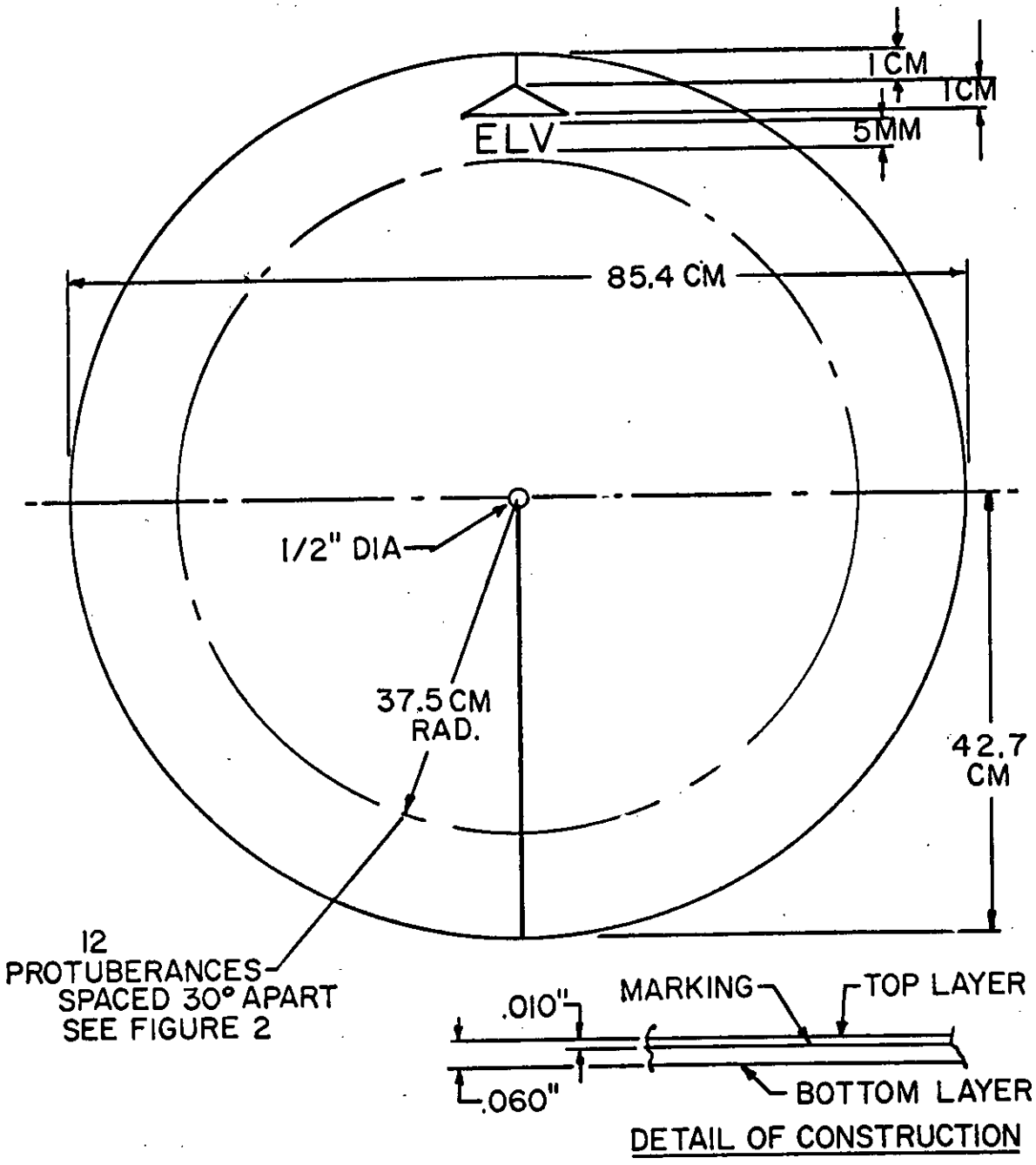
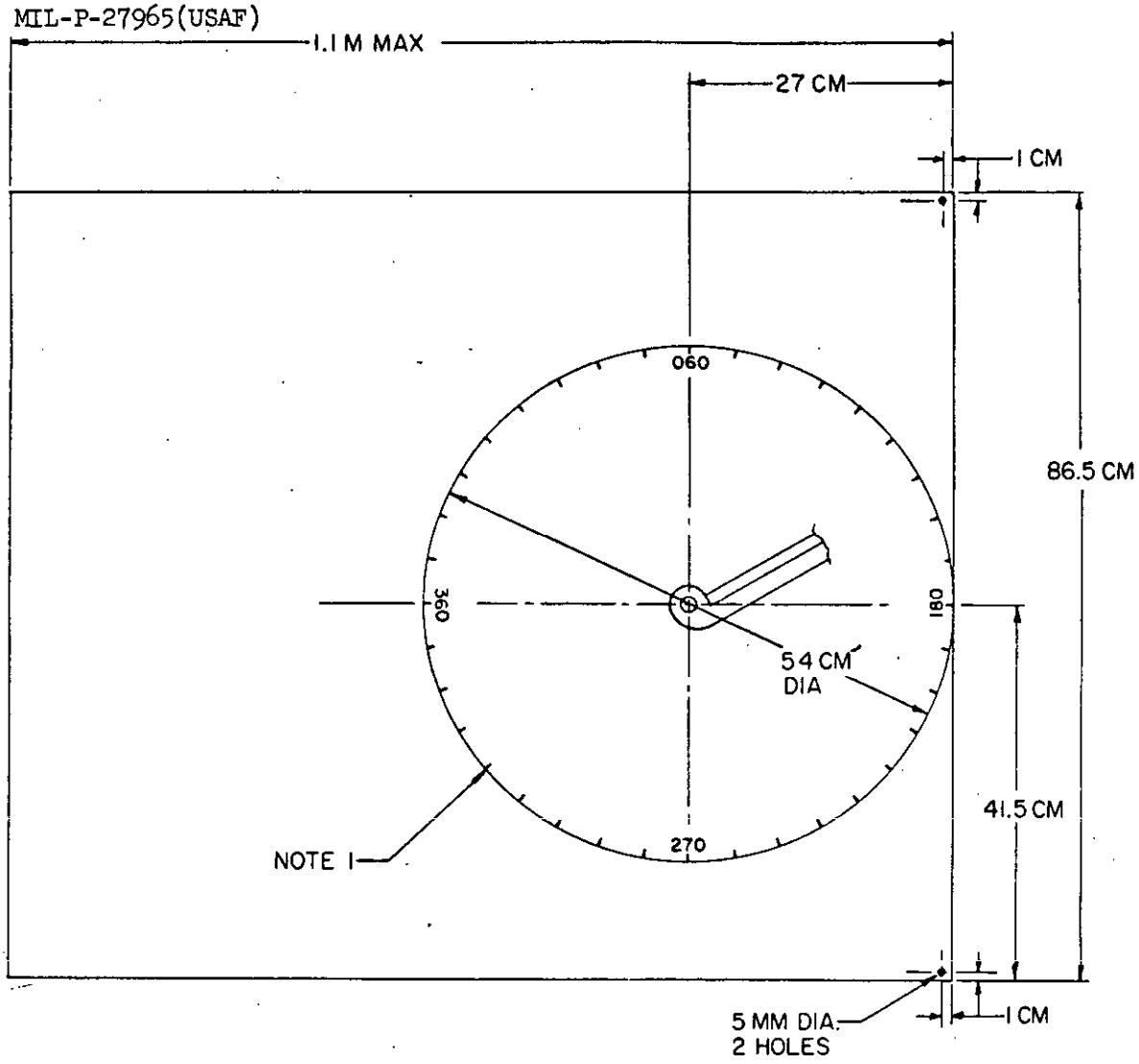
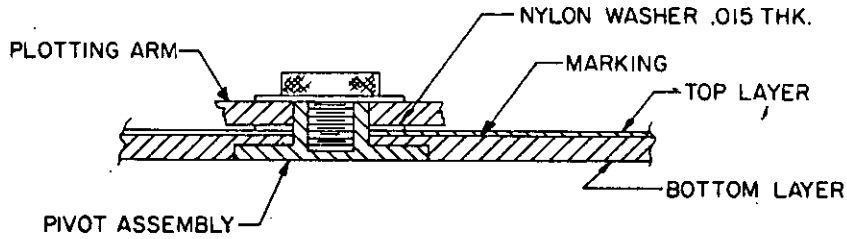


FIGURE 3. ELEVATION SCALE

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PLOTTING ARM ASSEMBLY

NOTES:
INTERMEDIATE GRADUATIONS AND MARKINGS NOT SHOWN, SEE PARA. 3.7.4.1
NOT TO SCALE.

FIGURE 4: AZIMUTH B SCALE

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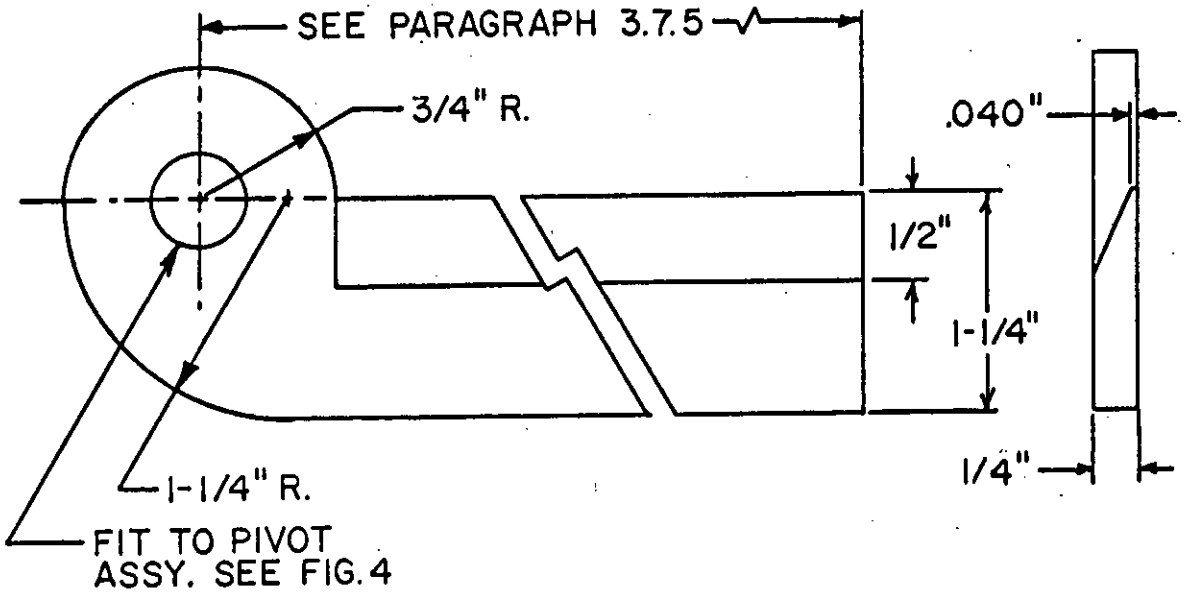


FIGURE 5: PLOTTING ARM
2 REQUIRED

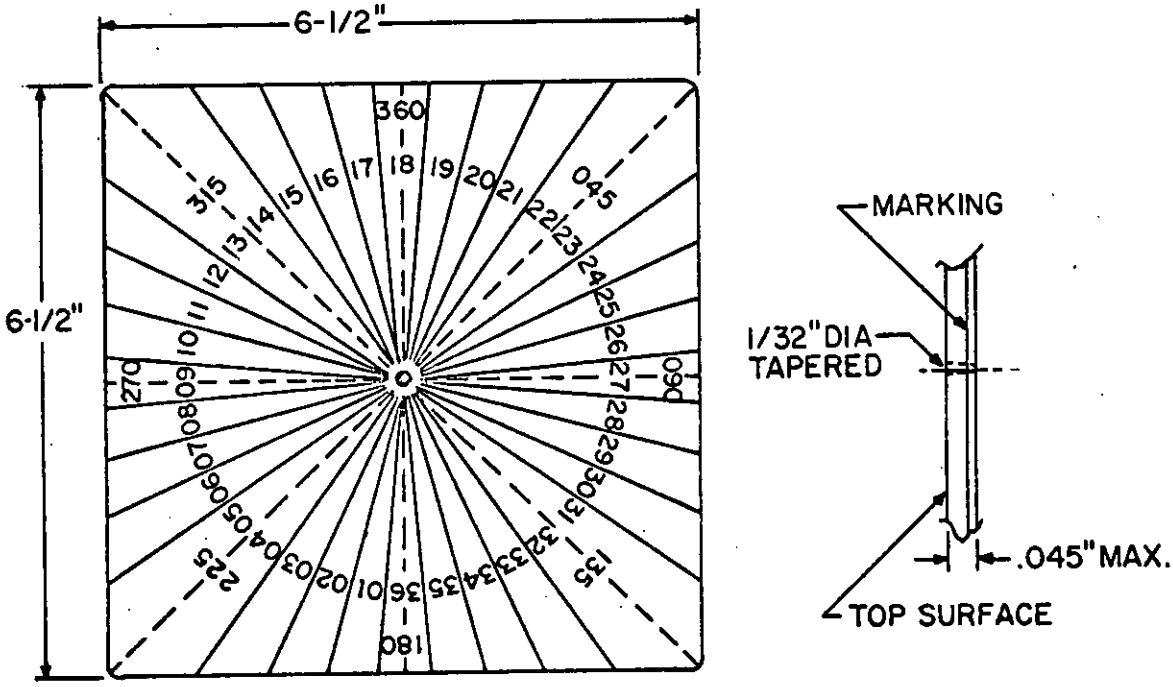
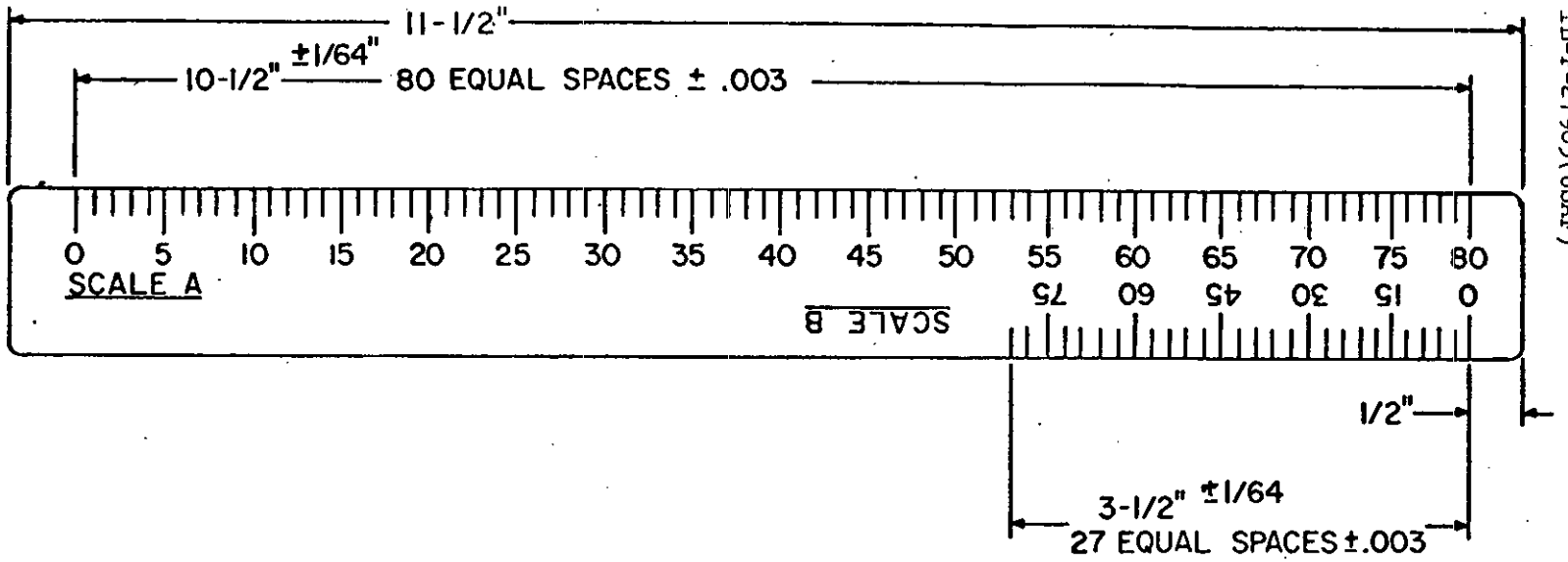
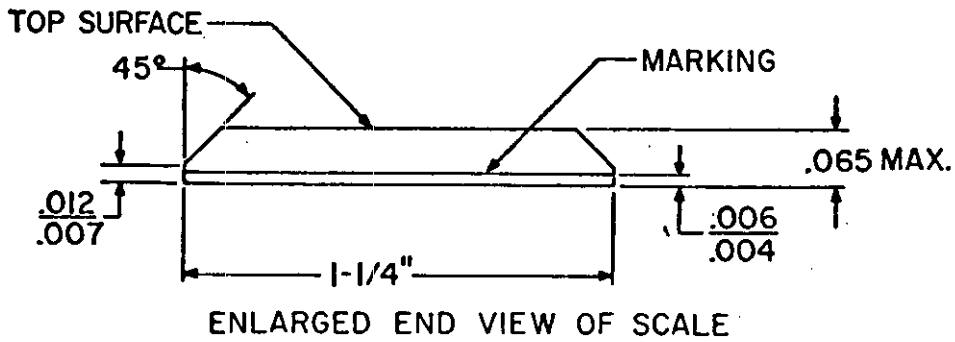


FIGURE 6: WIND DIRECTION SCALE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-20T13:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



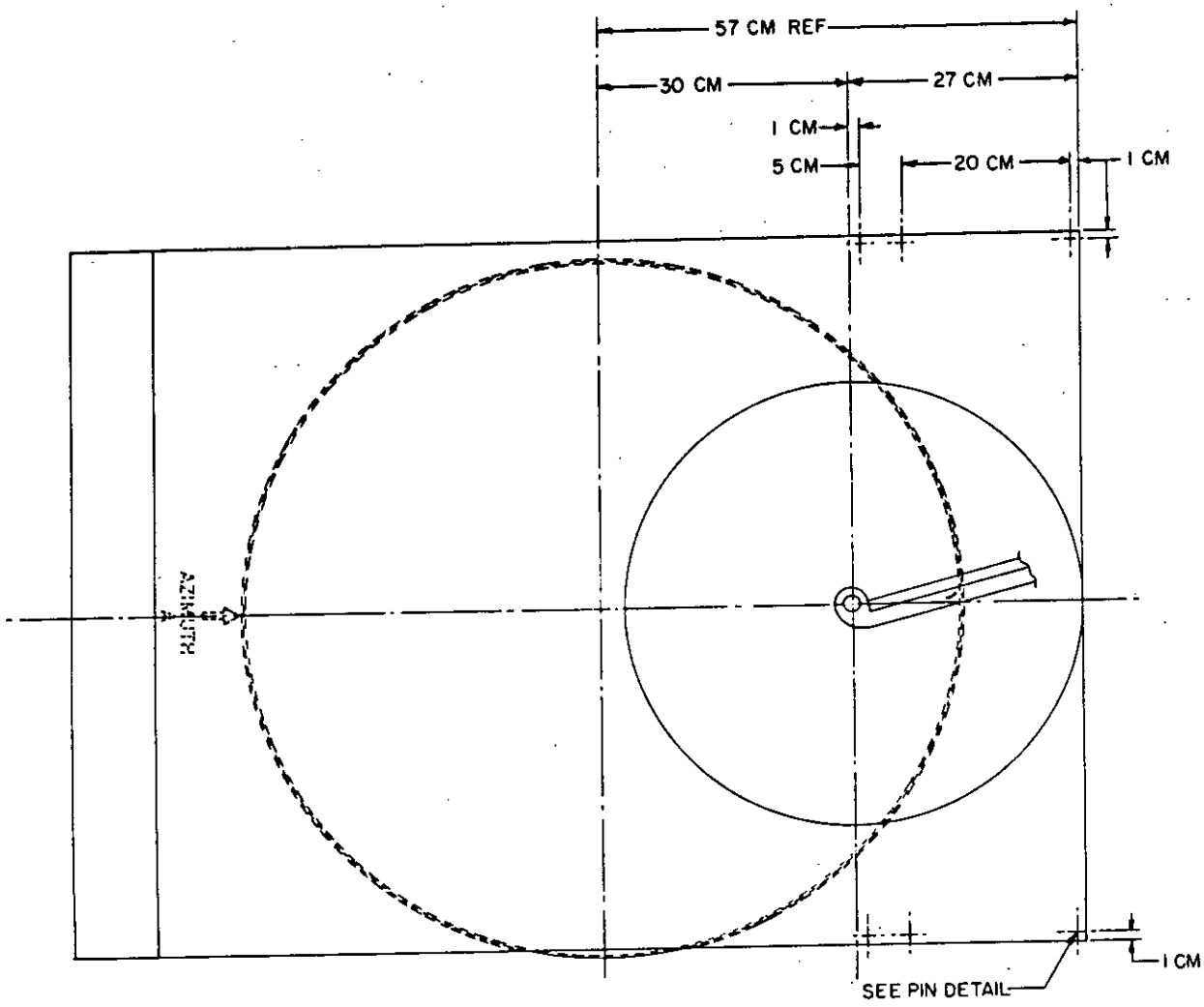


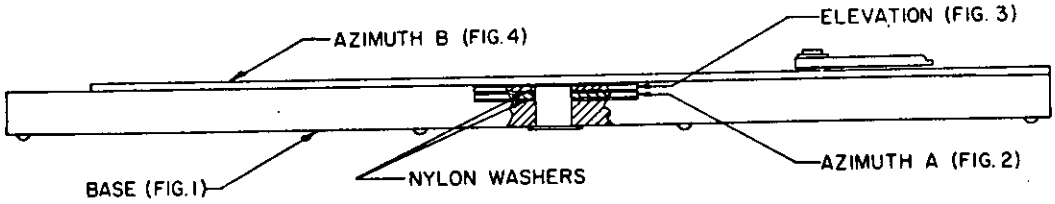
ENLARGED END VIEW OF SCALE

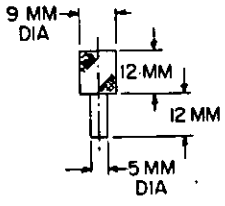
FIGURE 7: WIND SPEED SCALE

IL-P-27965(USAF)

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PIN DETAIL

FIGURE 8: ASSEMBLY

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NOTES:
1. ALL MARKINGS BLACK EXCEPT WHERE NOTED.

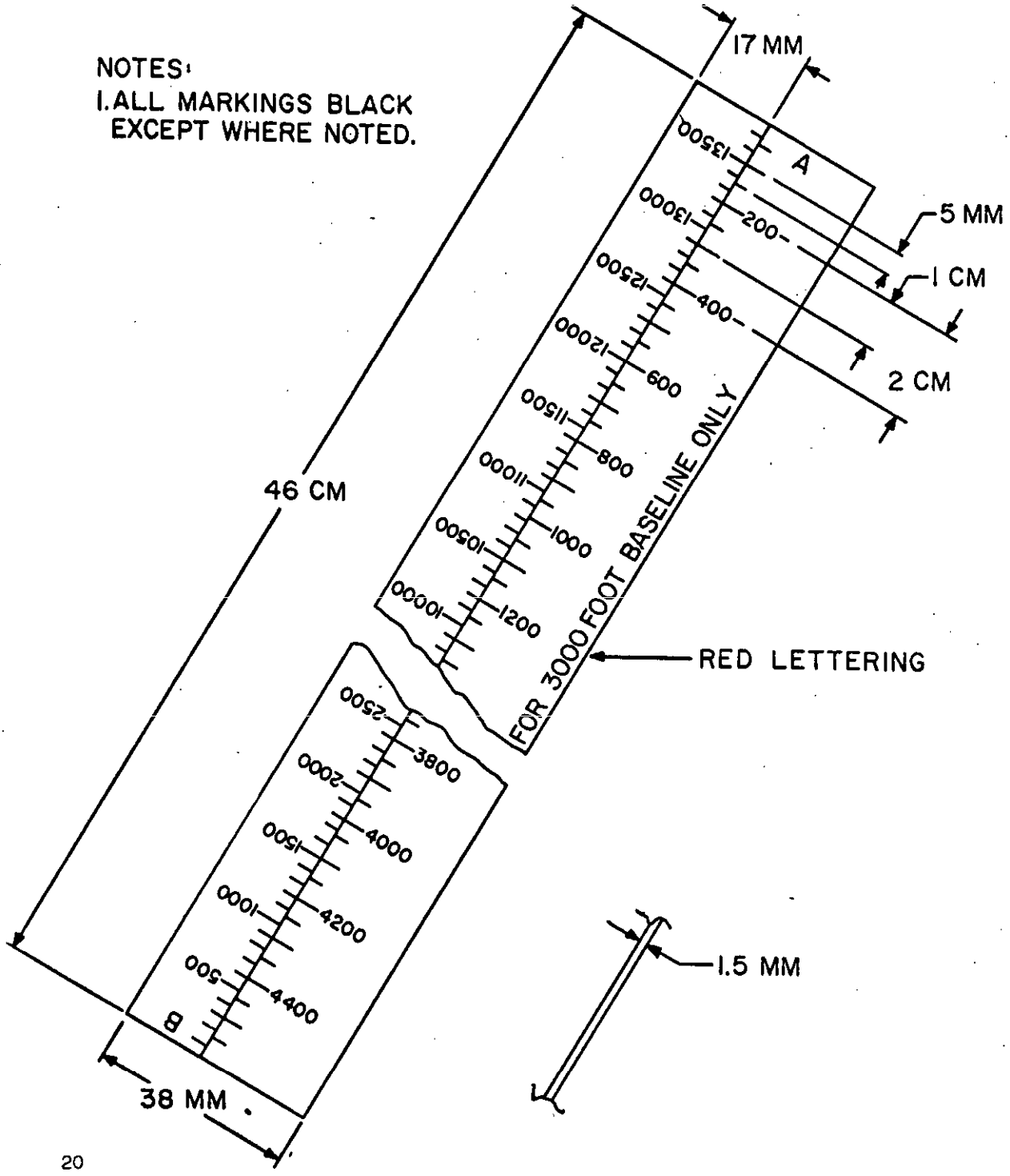


FIGURE 9: HEIGHT SCALE

GPO 303-222/Z .643

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